

Signal Channels Review

Rules, results and recommendations for the three Discord signal channels

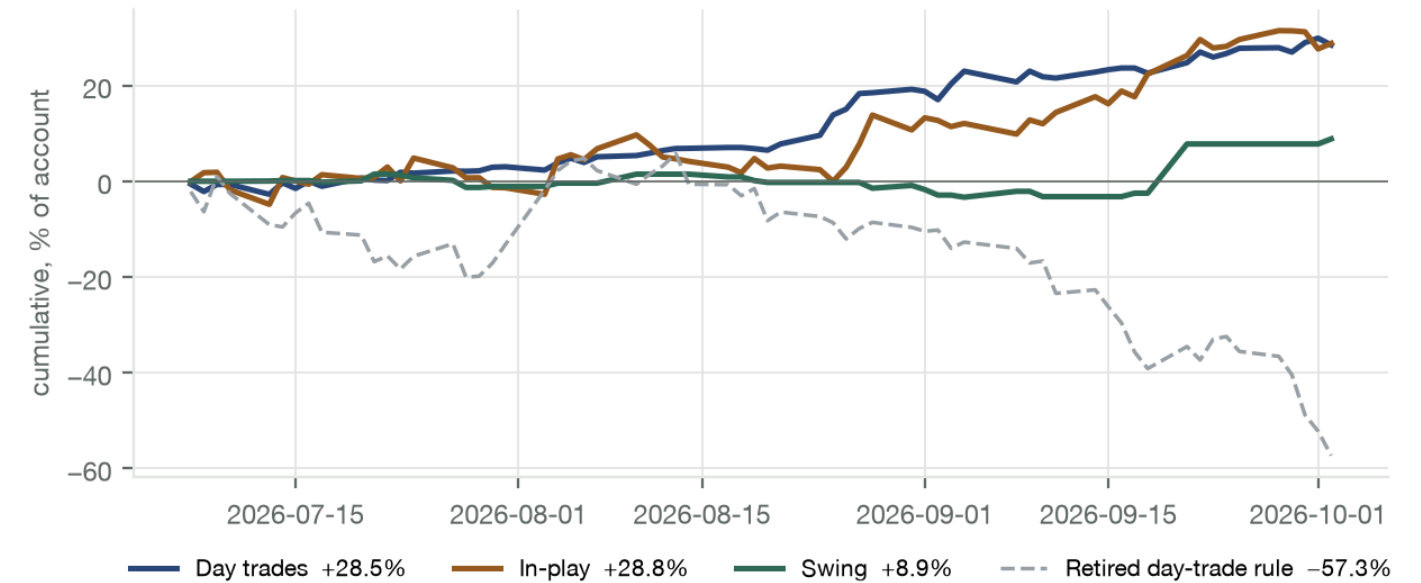
■ Day trades +28.5% last 3 months · 200 trades · PF 1.54	■ In-play +28.8% last 3 months · 242 trades · PF 1.28	■ Swing +8.9% last 3 months · 45 trades · PF 1.83
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Period covered: Tue 7 Jul – Fri 2 Oct 2026 (63 trading sessions)
Prepared: 4 October 2026 · Source: the bots' own code and backtests (tradingbot and vwap-ema-swing repositories)
All figures are backtests of the rules each channel runs now, not live trading results, unless stated. No orders are placed by any bot.

1. Executive summary

Channel	Last week			Last month			Last 3 months			Max drawdown (3 months)
	Total	Win	PF	Total	Win	PF	Total	Win	PF	
Day trades	+0.7%	52%	1.09	+11.4%	53%	1.48	+28.5%	50%	1.54	3.2%
In-play	-0.8%	43%	0.92	+16.1%	55%	1.49	+28.8%	49%	1.28	9.7%
Swing	+1.1%	100%	∞	+11.7%	76%	6.66	+8.9%	58%	1.83	4.8%
Retired day-trade rule	-21.7%	28%	0.27	-47.1%	36%	0.53	-57.3%	42%	0.79	64.1%

Day-trade figures: % of the account per trade at 1% risk. Swing: account % at 10% per position. PF = profit factor (gross wins ÷ gross losses). Drawdown = largest fall from a running peak.



Key findings

- **Both day-trade channels made money over one and three months; last week was flat.** Last week the day-trade channel finished +0.7% and the in-play channel -0.8%. Over 3 months they made +28.5% and +28.8%.
- **The day-trade channel has the best risk profile:** profit factor 1.54 and a 3.2% worst drawdown, against 1.28 and 9.7% for in-play. Its rule was rebuilt this week; it goes live on Monday 5 October.
- **The retired day-trade rule lost 57.3% over the same 3 months** (drawdown 64.1%). It was replaced on 3 October.
- **Swing had a strong month** (+11.7% of the account, 13 of 17 trades won) and +8.9% over 3 months, with SPY up about 2.4% over the same period. It holds 3 open positions.
- **The two day-trade channels overlap in part.** They traded the same stock on the same day 40 times in 3 months (20% of day-trade signals). Their daily results are only loosely related (correlation 0.17), so the overlap is in names, not in outcomes.
- **Most day-trade profit comes from holding to 15:55.** Trades that reach the end of day win most of the time; quick stop-outs before 10:30 are the largest single source of losses, and no filter tested so far predicts them.

Bottom line. All three current rules are positive over 1 and 3 months on backtests, and the retired rule's losses are gone. The evidence is still a backtest on free data with assumed costs. The next 30 trading sessions of the paper record, which logs real market prices at the moment each signal appears, should decide how far these channels are trusted and promoted.

2. Recommendations

Ordered by expected impact. Owners and timing are suggestions.

#	Recommendation	Why	When
1	Hold marketing claims until the forward record is in. Present backtests as backtests; no performance claims on the Discord page until 30 live sessions.	All results here are simulated. The day-trade edge is mostly recent: the earlier 9 months were near break-even.	Now – mid Nov
2	Review the paper record weekly (reports/orb_paper.md): win rate, real fill cost, and whether live signals match the backtest.	It is the only evidence not chosen in hindsight. Real costs above ~0.10% a side would erase the day-trade edge.	Weekly
3	Decide the in-play channel's role. Either re-test its rule with the same two-period method used on the day-trade rule, or merge it into the day-trade channel.	Its settings were picked on data that overlaps this report, its drawdown is 3× the day-trade channel's, and it trades many of the same stocks.	This month
4	Fix the live-vs-backtest stock-pick difference.	On 2 Oct the live code and the backtest chose 3 different stocks out of 10. Live signals must match what is reported.	Next week (task open)
5	Add market-holiday and early-close handling.	The bots assume a normal 09:30–16:00 session. Thanksgiving week (27 Nov early close) is the next risk.	Before 26 Nov
6	Move the live bots off GitHub's scheduler to a small always-on server (about \$5–10 a month).	GitHub starts scheduled jobs late or skips them under load; an opening job was skipped entirely in the first live week. Signals are only useful if they post in time.	When convenient
7	Watch swing concentration. Most swing trades are in five high-volatility names; consider a cap of 3 positions in crypto-linked names.	COIN, SHOP, HOOD, SMCI, PLTR account for 30 of 45 swing trades.	Next retune
8	Consider a paid data plan only if the forward record holds up.	Free IEX data is a small slice of the market: it limits stock selection and premarket data. Not worth paying for until the edge is confirmed live.	After Nov review

3. The three channels at a glance

	Day trades	In-play	Swing
Idea	The day's 10 most active stocks; trade the first clean break of the opening range	The day's 5 most active stocks; trade the opening-range break and hold to the close	Hourly trend turns on volatile large caps, held for days
Status	New rule live from 5 Oct 2026 (replaced the fixed-10 rule)	Live since 2 Oct 2026	Live since 1 Oct 2026
Holding period	Minutes to hours; always flat by 15:55	Minutes to hours; always flat by 15:55	About 4.0 days (median)
Signals per week	About 16	About 19	About 3.6
Data	Alpaca IEX one-minute bars (free feed), live and backtest		Alpaca hourly bars live; Yahoo hourly bars for backtests
Sizing shown	Results as % of account with each full stop = 1% of the account		10% of the account per position
Orders	None. All three channels post signals only. Automatic trading was turned off on 1 Oct 2026.		

4. Rules and exceptions

■ Day trades: opening-range breakout on stocks in play

Universe	About 105 liquid US stocks and ETFs. Price at least 5 and 14-day average dollar volume at least 50 million.
Selection	At 09:35 ET, rank by first-5-minute volume against the stock's own average for the same 5 minutes over the prior 14 sessions. Keep the top 10. The list is fixed for the day.
Opening range	High and low of the 09:30–09:34 one-minute bars. Must be at least 0.35 of the stock's 14-day average daily range, or the stock is skipped.
Entry	First completed one-minute close above the range high (long) or below the range low (short), on the 09:35–09:44 bars. Entry at that close.
Stop	The day's low (long) or high (short) so far, plus 0.02 of the daily range. Moved to the entry price once the trade is up by its initial risk.
Target and exit	Target at 2× the initial risk. Anything still open is closed at the 15:55 bar.
Limits	One trade per stock per day. Both directions. No market or SPY filter (testing showed trades that agreed with SPY did worse).
Costs assumed	0.05% slippage each way. Measured market quotes show a median round trip of about 0.045%.
Exceptions	A signal first seen more than 2 minutes after its bar closed posts as EXPIRED, never as a new entry. Signals are suppressed when market data is more than 3 minutes stale (a DATA WARNING posts instead). A failed data request posts a DATA ERROR, at most every 30 minutes. Holidays and early closes are not handled. A switch (DAYTRADE_STRATEGY) can return the channel to the retired rule.
Changes this week	No entries after 09:44 and stop to entry at +1× risk, adopted because both improved results on the last 3 months and the 9 months before (11 other candidate changes failed).

■ In-play channel

Universe	The same ~103-stock list. Price at least 5, 14-day ATR at least 0.50.
Selection	Top 5 by first-5-minute volume against the stock's own 14-session normal. The picks post to the channel each morning.
Entry	First completed one-minute close outside the 09:30–09:34 range, either direction. Entry at that close.
Stop	Half of the 14-day average daily range away from the entry.
Target and exit	No target. Out at the stop or at 15:55.
Limits and costs	One trade per stock per day; 0.05% slippage each way.
Exceptions	Entries first seen more than 2 minutes late post as EXPIRED. The channel also carries a silent paper record of the day-trade rule (nothing posts from it).

■ Swing: 21-hour trend line × weekly average price

Universe	A 25-stock pool. On the first trading day of each month, the 10 most volatile over the prior 120 days are traded. Current list: AMD, ARM, COIN, HOOD, MSTR, MU, ORCL, PLTR, SHOP, SMCI.
Entry	On hourly bars: the 21-hour EMA crosses above the weekly VWAP (volume-weighted average price, reset each week) and the bar closes above the VWAP. Longs only.
Market filter	SPY's own 21-hour EMA must be above SPY's weekly VWAP.
Exit	When the EMA closes back below the VWAP, after at least 7 hourly bars held and not in the first 2 bars of a new week (the VWAP has just reset). Protective stop 6 ATR below entry.
Earnings	No new entry within 2 trading days of an earnings report; open positions exit before the report.
Options idea	Each entry suggests a call about 0.85 delta, 21–30 days out, with a bid-ask spread under 8% and implied volatility under 200%.
Exceptions	Signals post shortly after each hourly close; a daily recap posts after the close. The weekly retune checks nearby settings but changes them only if the holdout improves.

5. Day trades: results

The rule the channel runs from 5 Oct, replayed on the last 63 sessions.

Each result is one trade as a share of the account, sized so a full stop costs 1%.

Week, month and 3 months

	Trades	Won / lost	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Profit factor	Max drawdown	Green days	Best	Worst
Last week	21	11 / 10	52%	+0.03%	+0.7%	1.09	2.7%	3 / 5	+1.97%	-1.08%
Mon 28 Sep - Fri 2 Oct										
Last month	77	41 / 36	53%	+0.15%	+11.4%	1.48	2.7%	13 / 21	+1.98%	-1.08%
Thu 3 Sep - Fri 2 Oct										
Last 3 months	200	101 / 99	50%	+0.14%	+28.5%	1.54	3.2%	38 / 63	+1.98%	-1.09%
Tue 7 Jul - Fri 2 Oct										

Last week, day by day

Day	Trades	Won / lost	Win rate	Day total	Best trade	Worst trade
Mon 28 Sep	5	3 / 2	60%	+0.11%	BA +1.02%	KO -1.08%
Tue 29 Sep	5	1 / 4	20%	-0.92%	NVDA +1.02%	CRM -1.03%
Wed 30 Sep	5	4 / 1	80%	+1.99%	PG +1.93%	MSFT -0.62%
Thu 1 Oct	2	1 / 1	50%	+0.93%	GOOGL +1.97%	AAPL -1.04%
Fri 2 Oct	4	2 / 2	50%	-1.42%	NKE +0.61%	BA -1.04%
Week	21	11 / 10	52%	+0.69%		

Month by month (3-month window)

Month	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Profit factor
Jul 2026	51	45%	+0.06%	+3.1%	1.21
Aug 2026	63	54%	+0.26%	+16.2%	2.52
Sep 2026	80	51%	+0.12%	+9.8%	1.40
Oct 2026	6	50%	-0.08%	-0.5%	0.84

Daily results, last month



Day trades: breakdowns (3 months)

All figures are % of the account per trade at 1% risk.

By ticker (most traded)

Ticker	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
CRWD	14	64%	+0.61%	+8.57%	+1.98%	-1.02%
CRM	10	60%	+0.50%	+5.03%	+1.98%	-1.03%
HOOD	9	44%	-0.20%	-1.84%	+1.19%	-1.03%
TSLA	9	67%	+0.47%	+4.23%	+1.98%	-0.15%
META	8	62%	+0.42%	+3.37%	+1.97%	-0.70%
AAPL	7	29%	-0.19%	-1.31%	+0.89%	-1.04%
AMZN	7	43%	-0.12%	-0.86%	+0.30%	-0.62%
KO	7	43%	+0.14%	+0.98%	+1.97%	-1.08%
JPM	6	50%	+0.15%	+0.93%	+0.95%	-1.04%
PLTR	6	50%	+0.25%	+1.50%	+1.69%	-1.03%
MSFT	6	67%	+0.02%	+0.13%	+0.41%	-0.62%
SMCI	6	33%	-0.22%	-1.33%	+0.27%	-1.02%
UNH	6	50%	+0.27%	+1.63%	+1.97%	-1.03%
FCX	5	40%	-0.28%	-1.42%	+0.77%	-1.03%
GOOGL	5	60%	+0.57%	+2.85%	+1.97%	-0.69%

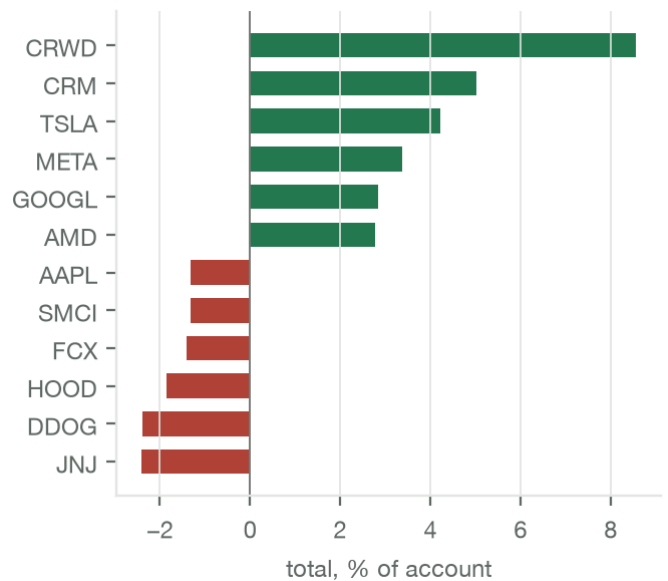
By entry time

Entry	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
09:35-09:39	156	52%	+0.13%	+20.43%	+1.98%	-1.09%
09:40-09:44	44	45%	+0.18%	+8.09%	+1.98%	-1.07%

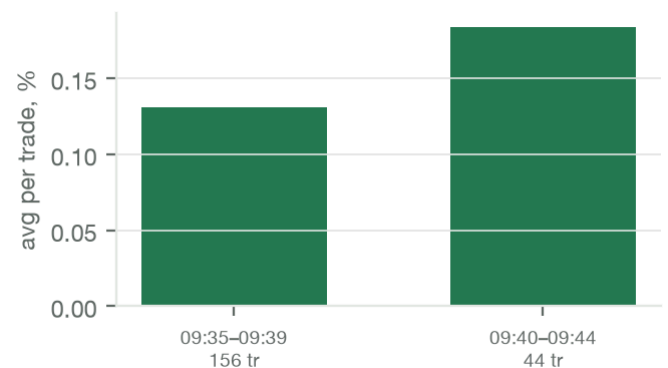
By exit time

Exit	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
before 10:30	15	13%	-0.63%	-9.49%	+1.98%	-1.09%
10:30-11:59	23	17%	-0.34%	-7.77%	+1.98%	-1.07%
12:00-13:59	10	50%	+0.67%	+6.70%	+1.98%	-1.04%
14:00-15:54	11	27%	+0.05%	+0.59%	+1.98%	-1.06%
15:55 (end of day)	141	62%	+0.27%	+38.49%	+1.69%	-0.70%

Total by ticker: best and worst



Average per trade by entry time



By day of week

Day	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
Monday	36	53%	+0.17%	+5.96%	+1.98%	-1.08%
Tuesday	42	40%	+0.16%	+6.74%	+1.98%	-1.03%
Wednesday	41	51%	+0.04%	+1.57%	+1.97%	-1.09%
Thursday	41	61%	+0.29%	+11.74%	+1.98%	-1.07%
Friday	40	48%	+0.06%	+2.51%	+1.97%	-1.04%

Long vs short

Direction	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
long	110	48%	+0.07%	+7.75%	+1.98%	-1.09%
short	90	53%	+0.23%	+20.77%	+1.98%	-1.08%

Most often picked (of 10 a day)

Ticker	Days picked	Traded	Conversion
INTC	22	5	23%
KO	21	7	33%
FCX	21	5	24%
CRWD	21	14	67%
TSLA	21	9	43%
JPM	21	6	29%
ORCL	19	3	16%
CRM	18	10	56%
GOOGL	18	5	28%
BAC	18	5	28%
MSFT	17	6	35%
NVDA	17	5	29%
HOOD	17	9	53%
WMT	17	5	29%
AAPL	16	7	44%

How trades ended

Exit	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
Closed at 15:55	141	62%	+0.27%	+38.49%	+1.69%	-0.70%
Hit stop	45	0%	-0.83%	-37.54%	-0.01%	-1.09%
Hit target	14	100%	+1.97%	+27.57%	+1.98%	+1.93%

What happened to the picks

Outcome	Picks	Share
range too narrow	303	48%
traded	200	32%
no breakout before 09:45	127	20%

A pick is skipped when its opening range is too small relative to its normal daily move, or when it doesn't break out by 09:44.

Day trades: every trade last week

Day	Ticker	Side	In → out	Entry	Stop	Target	Exit	How it ended	Result
Mon 28 Sep	BA	short	09:35 → 15:55	188.86	192.71	181.15	184.84	Closed at 15:55	+1.02%
Mon 28 Sep	NVDA	long	09:35 → 10:46	232.76	229.41	239.46	229.41	Hit stop	-1.03%
Mon 28 Sep	QCOM	short	09:35 → 15:55	192.99	199.23	180.52	187.55	Closed at 15:55	+0.86%
Mon 28 Sep	META	short	09:36 → 15:55	723.20	750.11	669.40	713.69	Closed at 15:55	+0.34%
Mon 28 Sep	KO	short	09:39 → 10:09	87.06	87.63	85.90	87.63	Hit stop	-1.08%
Tue 29 Sep	WMT	short	09:35 → 15:55	106.23	107.90	102.90	106.71	Closed at 15:55	-0.32%
Tue 29 Sep	NVDA	short	09:36 → 15:55	230.20	232.91	224.77	227.30	Closed at 15:55	+1.02%
Tue 29 Sep	TSLA	short	09:37 → 15:55	352.43	358.79	339.72	352.98	Closed at 15:55	-0.11%
Tue 29 Sep	BA	long	09:42 → 15:55	189.59	185.17	198.43	187.55	Closed at 15:55	-0.48%
Tue 29 Sep	CRM	short	09:43 → 10:13	223.57	227.68	215.34	227.68	Hit stop	-1.03%
Wed 30 Sep	HOOD	short	09:35 → 15:55	113.45	123.43	93.49	112.72	Closed at 15:55	+0.07%
Wed 30 Sep	MSTR	short	09:35 → 15:55	156.74	163.45	143.33	153.59	Closed at 15:55	+0.46%
Wed 30 Sep	SMCI	short	09:35 → 15:55	41.44	42.72	38.88	41.22	Closed at 15:55	+0.15%
Wed 30 Sep	PG	short	09:36 → 15:03	148.14	149.16	146.08	146.08	Hit target	+1.93%
Wed 30 Sep	MSFT	long	09:37 → 15:55	516.16	510.19	528.09	512.73	Closed at 15:55	-0.62%
Thu 1 Oct	AAPL	long	09:35 → 11:32	332.02	328.24	339.57	328.24	Hit stop	-1.04%
Thu 1 Oct	GOOGL	short	09:36 → 12:49	347.90	353.17	337.35	337.35	Hit target	+1.97%
Fri 2 Oct	HOOD	long	09:35 → 11:46	118.74	113.35	129.52	113.35	Hit stop	-1.01%
Fri 2 Oct	NKE	long	09:36 → 15:55	33.14	31.96	35.50	33.88	Closed at 15:55	+0.61%
Fri 2 Oct	TSLA	long	09:39 → 15:55	369.78	359.26	390.84	370.20	Closed at 15:55	+0.02%
Fri 2 Oct	BA	short	09:43 → 14:35	192.76	195.45	187.38	195.45	Hit stop	-1.04%

6. In-play: results

The rule the channel runs now, replayed on the last 63 sessions.

Each result is one trade as a share of the account, sized so a full stop costs 1%.

Week, month and 3 months

	Trades	Won / lost	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Profit factor	Max drawdown	Green days	Best	Worst
Last week	23	10 / 13	43%	-0.04%	-0.8%	0.92	4.9%	2 / 5	+2.35%	-1.06%
Mon 28 Sep – Fri 2 Oct										
Last month	88	48 / 40	55%	+0.18%	+16.1%	1.49	4.9%	12 / 21	+3.56%	-1.07%
Thu 3 Sep – Fri 2 Oct										
Last 3 months	242	119 / 123	49%	+0.12%	+28.8%	1.28	9.7%	30 / 63	+4.96%	-1.11%
Tue 7 Jul – Fri 2 Oct										

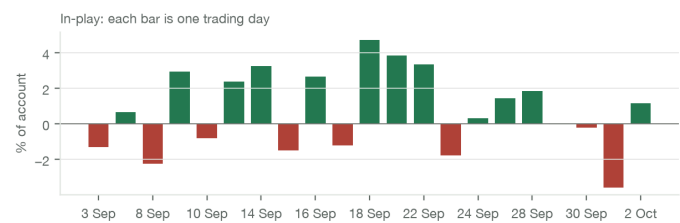
Last week, day by day

Day	Trades	Won / lost	Win rate	Day total	Best trade	Worst trade
Mon 28 Sep	5	4 / 1	80%	+1.84%	BA +1.39%	APD -1.06%
Tue 29 Sep	4	2 / 2	50%	-0.03%	TGT +0.40%	WMT -0.59%
Wed 30 Sep	4	2 / 2	50%	-0.21%	ZM +1.20%	NOC -1.05%
Thu 1 Oct	5	0 / 5	0%	-3.57%	ABNB -0.30%	IBM -1.04%
Fri 2 Oct	5	2 / 3	40%	+1.16%	RIVN +2.35%	WMT -1.05%
Week	23	10 / 13	43%	-0.82%		

Month by month (3-month window)

Month	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Profit factor
Jul 2026	69	48%	-0.02%	-1.3%	0.96
Aug 2026	78	44%	+0.15%	+12.1%	1.34
Sep 2026	85	59%	+0.24%	+20.5%	1.72
Oct 2026	10	20%	-0.24%	-2.4%	0.62

Daily results, last month



In-play: breakdowns (3 months)

All figures are % of the account per trade at 1% risk.

By ticker (most traded)

Ticker	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
TRV	6	17%	-0.26%	-1.55%	+3.47%	-1.06%
TGT	6	83%	+0.26%	+1.57%	+0.56%	-0.56%
BABA	6	50%	+0.12%	+0.70%	+1.79%	-1.03%
ZM	5	60%	+0.23%	+1.14%	+1.55%	-1.03%
CVNA	5	60%	-0.06%	-0.31%	+0.94%	-1.02%
SHOP	5	60%	+0.30%	+1.52%	+1.45%	-1.02%
BA	5	60%	-0.05%	-0.26%	+1.39%	-1.04%
DKNG	5	0%	-0.97%	-4.86%	-0.76%	-1.03%
U	4	50%	+0.12%	+0.47%	+2.08%	-1.02%
SBUX	4	0%	-1.04%	-4.17%	-1.04%	-1.05%
RIVN	4	50%	+0.42%	+1.68%	+2.35%	-1.03%
IBM	4	25%	-0.52%	-2.06%	+1.05%	-1.04%
ETN	4	100%	+0.92%	+3.68%	+1.82%	+0.22%
ENPH	4	25%	-0.06%	-0.23%	+2.08%	-1.02%
DDOG	4	0%	-0.80%	-3.21%	-0.15%	-1.03%

By entry time

Entry	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
09:35-09:39	130	54%	+0.25%	+32.76%	+4.96%	-1.11%
09:40-09:44	57	40%	-0.14%	-7.92%	+3.56%	-1.07%
09:45-09:59	51	47%	+0.05%	+2.79%	+4.56%	-1.06%
10:00-10:59	4	50%	+0.30%	+1.21%	+0.96%	-0.60%

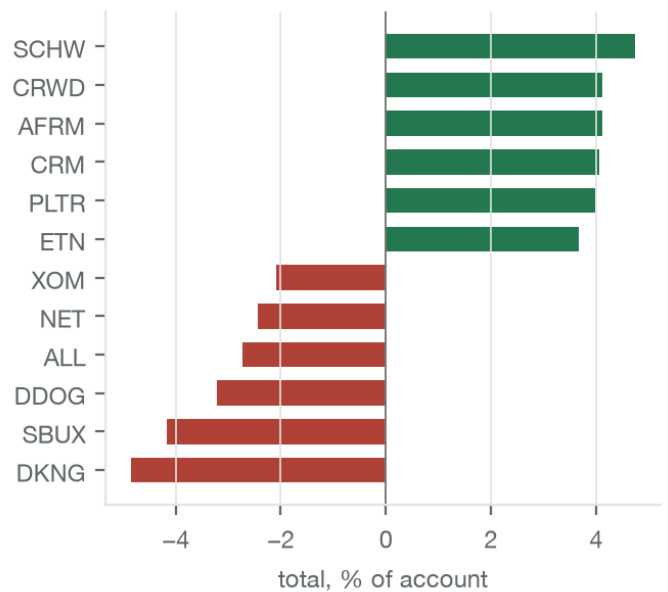
By exit time

Exit	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
before 10:30	44	0%	-1.03%	-45.46%	-1.01%	-1.06%
10:30-11:59	19	0%	-1.04%	-19.70%	-1.02%	-1.07%
12:00-13:59	12	0%	-1.04%	-12.49%	-1.02%	-1.11%
14:00-15:54	8	0%	-1.03%	-8.27%	-1.02%	-1.06%
15:55 (end of day)	159	75%	+0.72%	+114.77%	+4.96%	-0.98%

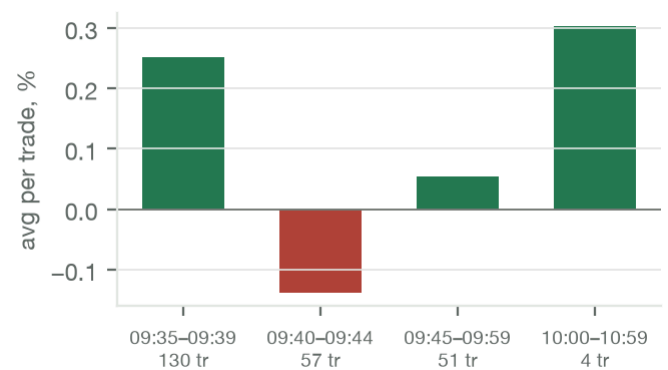
Long vs short

Direction	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
long	117	44%	+0.12%	+14.03%	+4.96%	-1.11%
short	125	54%	+0.12%	+14.82%	+4.56%	-1.07%

Total by ticker: best and worst



Average per trade by entry time



By day of week

Day	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
Monday	40	48%	-0.01%	-0.38%	+2.62%	-1.11%
Tuesday	45	42%	+0.17%	+7.51%	+3.99%	-1.07%
Wednesday	53	57%	+0.20%	+10.72%	+2.36%	-1.06%
Thursday	51	37%	-0.21%	-10.67%	+4.96%	-1.07%
Friday	53	60%	+0.41%	+21.67%	+4.56%	-1.05%

How trades ended

Exit	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
Closed at 15:55	159	75%	+0.72%	+114.77%	+4.96%	-0.98%
Hit stop	83	0%	-1.04%	-85.93%	-1.01%	-1.11%

In-play: every trade last week

Day	Ticker	Side	In → out	Entry	Stop	Target	Exit	How it ended	Result
Mon 28 Sep	CVNA	short	09:35 → 15:55	61.47	62.87	–	60.62	Closed at 15:55	+0.61%
Mon 28 Sep	BA	short	09:35 → 15:55	188.86	191.68	–	184.93	Closed at 15:55	+1.39%
Mon 28 Sep	DOW	short	09:35 → 15:55	27.98	28.43	–	27.90	Closed at 15:55	+0.18%
Mon 28 Sep	SNOW	long	09:37 → 15:55	323.14	316.99	–	327.55	Closed at 15:55	+0.72%
Mon 28 Sep	APD	long	09:47 → 11:11	281.44	278.94	–	278.80	Hit stop	–1.06%
Tue 29 Sep	WMT	short	09:35 → 15:55	106.23	107.13	–	106.76	Closed at 15:55	–0.59%
Tue 29 Sep	AFRM	long	09:38 → 15:55	69.31	67.71	–	69.28	Closed at 15:55	–0.02%
Tue 29 Sep	CVNA	long	09:41 → 15:55	63.36	61.86	–	63.62	Closed at 15:55	+0.18%
Tue 29 Sep	TGT	short	09:42 → 15:55	157.04	158.82	–	156.31	Closed at 15:55	+0.40%
Wed 30 Sep	NOC	long	09:35 → 10:14	487.14	482.04	–	481.80	Hit stop	–1.05%
Wed 30 Sep	HOOD	short	09:35 → 09:40	113.45	116.28	–	116.34	Hit stop	–1.02%
Wed 30 Sep	ZM	long	09:36 → 15:55	89.39	88.12	–	90.93	Closed at 15:55	+1.20%
Wed 30 Sep	LOW	short	09:52 → 15:55	186.30	188.10	–	185.13	Closed at 15:55	+0.65%
Thu 1 Oct	IBM	long	09:35 → 09:40	233.89	230.71	–	230.59	Hit stop	–1.04%
Thu 1 Oct	HD	short	09:36 → 15:55	281.78	284.81	–	282.73	Closed at 15:55	–0.31%
Thu 1 Oct	ABNB	short	09:40 → 15:55	159.74	162.23	–	160.50	Closed at 15:55	–0.30%
Thu 1 Oct	ZM	short	09:41 → 12:12	90.83	92.16	–	92.21	Hit stop	–1.03%
Thu 1 Oct	MS	short	09:41 → 15:55	185.79	188.26	–	187.97	Closed at 15:55	–0.89%
Fri 2 Oct	NKE	long	09:36 → 15:55	33.14	32.67	–	33.86	Closed at 15:55	+1.54%
Fri 2 Oct	RIVN	short	09:38 → 15:55	14.93	15.24	–	14.21	Closed at 15:55	+2.35%
Fri 2 Oct	TXN	long	09:42 → 15:55	295.54	292.10	–	293.38	Closed at 15:55	–0.63%
Fri 2 Oct	WMT	long	09:45 → 10:02	105.18	104.17	–	104.12	Hit stop	–1.05%
Fri 2 Oct	SPGI	long	09:46 → 11:11	387.27	383.44	–	383.25	Hit stop	–1.05%

7. Swing: results

Trades counted on the day they closed.

Account figures assume 10% of the account per position (trade return ÷ 10). Trade-level returns are the move on the shares.

Week, month and 3 months

	Trades	Won / lost	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Profit factor	Max drawdown	Green days	Best	Worst
Last week	2	2 / 0	100%	+0.53%	+1.1%	∞	0.0%	1 / 5	+0.92%	+0.14%
Mon 28 Sep – Fri 2 Oct										
Last month	17	13 / 4	76%	+0.69%	+11.7%	6.66	1.1%	4 / 21	+2.89%	−1.11%
Thu 3 Sep – Fri 2 Oct										
Last 3 months	45	26 / 19	58%	+0.20%	+8.9%	1.83	4.8%	13 / 63	+2.89%	−1.49%
Tue 7 Jul – Fri 2 Oct										

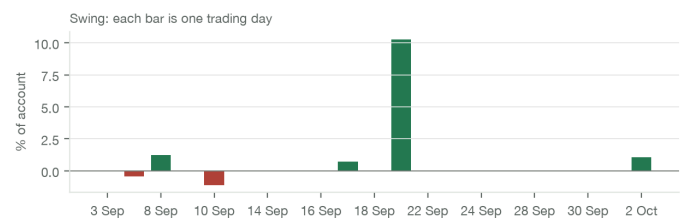
Last week, day by day

Day	Trades	Won / lost	Win rate	Day total	Best trade	Worst trade
Mon 28 Sep	0	–	–	0.00%		–
Tue 29 Sep	0	–	–	0.00%		–
Wed 30 Sep	0	–	–	0.00%		–
Thu 1 Oct	0	–	–	0.00%		–
Fri 2 Oct	2	2 / 0	100%	+1.06%	SHOP +0.92%	SMCI +0.14%
Week	2	2 / 0	100%	+1.06%		

Month by month (3-month window)

Month	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Profit factor
Jul 2026	11	55%	−0.10%	−1.0%	0.67
Aug 2026	14	50%	+0.01%	+0.2%	1.06
Sep 2026	18	61%	+0.48%	+8.7%	3.11
Oct 2026	2	100%	+0.53%	+1.1%	∞

Daily results, last month



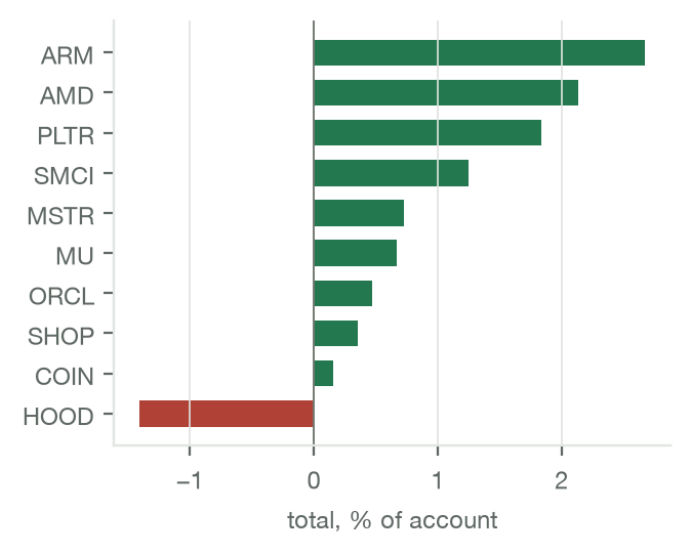
Swing: breakdowns (3 months)

All swing figures in these tables are account % at 10% of the account per position.

By ticker (most traded)

Ticker	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
COIN	7	43%	+0.02%	+0.16%	+1.42%	-1.11%
HOOD	6	17%	-0.23%	-1.41%	+0.49%	-0.58%
SHOP	6	67%	+0.06%	+0.35%	+0.92%	-0.76%
SMCI	6	83%	+0.21%	+1.25%	+0.72%	-0.52%
PLTR	5	80%	+0.37%	+1.84%	+1.05%	-0.44%
ORCL	4	75%	+0.12%	+0.47%	+0.96%	-1.08%
AMD	3	67%	+0.71%	+2.13%	+2.56%	-0.53%
MSTR	3	33%	+0.24%	+0.72%	+2.15%	-1.16%
MU	3	67%	+0.22%	+0.67%	+1.36%	-1.49%
ARM	2	50%	+1.34%	+2.67%	+2.89%	-0.21%

Total by ticker: best and worst



By entry hour

Entry bar	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
09:30	5	80%	+0.84%	+4.20%	+2.15%	-0.06%
10:30	12	75%	+0.82%	+9.83%	+2.89%	-0.58%
11:30	5	40%	-0.38%	-1.92%	+0.49%	-1.49%
12:30	6	33%	-0.24%	-1.46%	+0.80%	-1.08%
13:30	8	75%	+0.04%	+0.34%	+0.96%	-1.16%
14:30	8	25%	-0.28%	-2.22%	+0.58%	-1.11%
15:30	1	100%	+0.10%	+0.10%	+0.10%	+0.10%

By holding time

Held	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
under 1 day	1	100%	+0.14%	+0.14%	+0.14%	+0.14%
1-3 days	10	40%	+0.03%	+0.34%	+1.42%	-0.68%
3-7 days	30	57%	+0.02%	+0.63%	+2.15%	-1.49%
7+ days	4	100%	+1.94%	+7.77%	+2.89%	+0.96%

By entry day

Day	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
Monday	10	80%	+1.01%	+10.10%	+2.89%	-0.58%
Tuesday	2	100%	+0.29%	+0.57%	+0.31%	+0.26%
Wednesday	6	50%	-0.11%	-0.66%	+0.96%	-1.49%
Thursday	18	33%	-0.30%	-5.34%	+0.80%	-1.16%
Friday	9	78%	+0.47%	+4.20%	+2.15%	-0.16%

How trades ended

Exit	Trades	Win rate	Avg / trade	Total	Best	Worst
Hit stop	4	0%	-1.11%	-4.44%	-0.76%	-1.49%
Still open (at 2 Oct close)	2	100%	+0.53%	+1.06%	+0.92%	+0.14%
Trend turned (exit signal)	39	62%	+0.31%	+12.25%	+2.89%	-1.16%

Open positions now

Ticker	Entered	Entry price	Stop	Suggested call
SHOP	2026-09-28 10:30	138.56	124.25	-
MSTR	2026-10-02 12:30	159.54	140.50	MSTR261023C00135000
SMCI	2026-10-02 13:30	43.04	38.31	SMCI261030C00036000

Swing: every trade last week

Ticker	Entry	Exit	Entry px	Exit px	Days	Stock move	Account
SHOP	2026-09-28 10:30	2026-10-02 15:30	138.55	151.39	4.2	+9.17%	+0.92%
SMCI	2026-10-02 13:30	2026-10-02 15:30	43.04	43.68	0.1	+1.39%	+0.14%

8. Day-trade channel: retired rule vs current rule

Rule	Week	Month	3 months	Trades (3 mo)	Win rate	PF	Max drawdown
Retired rule (fixed 10 large stocks, until 2 Oct)	-21.7%	-47.1%	-57.3%	551	42%	0.79	64.1%
Current rule (stocks in play, from 5 Oct)	+0.7%	+11.4%	+28.5%	200	50%	1.54	3.2%

The retired rule traded opening-range breaks on the same 10 large stocks every day. It lost money in every period tested (12 months of data, three separate date ranges), and its live sessions on 29–30 September matched: 44 signals, 15 winners. The current rule chooses stocks each morning by unusual activity, skips stocks whose opening range is too small, and stops taking entries at 09:45.

How the current rule was chosen

- **12-month study (2 Oct):** dates split in order into training, validation and an untouched test period. Only two changes survived: choosing the 10 most active stocks, and requiring a wide enough opening range.
- **Real costs checked (3 Oct):** 1,018 trades re-priced against actual market quotes. A typical round trip cost 0.045%, half the 0.10% assumed.
- **Robustness checks:** results are positive but thin when tested on a list of every listed stock or on consolidated data. That is why the paper record matters.
- **Improvements (3 Oct):** 13 changes suggested by the trade-level analysis, each tested on the last 3 months and the 9 months before. Two passed: no entries after 09:44, stop to entry at +1× risk.

9. Risks, data quality and open issues

Area	Issue	Effect
Evidence	Everything here is a backtest. The day-trade rule's improvements were found on part of this same period, and the in-play rule's settings were chosen on data that overlaps it.	Results are likely better than what live trading will show.
Edge strength	Over the 9 months before this window, the day-trade rule was close to break-even (about +0.02% per trade).	A good recent stretch could be a favourable market rather than a lasting edge.
Costs	At 0.10% slippage per side, the day-trade rule loses money on the earlier 9 months.	Fill quality decides the result. The paper record now logs real quotes for every signal.
Data	The free IEX feed is a small slice of market volume; no usable premarket data live.	Stock selection is noisier than with full-market data.
Live vs backtest	On 2 Oct, the live code and the backtest picked 3 different stocks out of 10.	Live signals can differ from reported results. Fix in progress.
Overlap	The two day-trade channels traded the same stock on the same day 40 times; daily correlation 0.17.	Members following both are doubled up on those 40 trades.
Operations	Bots run on GitHub's scheduler, which can start late or skip runs. Holidays and early closes aren't handled.	Missed or late signals on some days.
Swing	Concentrated in a handful of volatile names; one trade can move the month (best trade +28.9% on the shares, worst -14.9%).	Monthly results swing widely.

10. Appendix: definitions and sources

Win rate	Share of trades that made money after costs.
Avg / trade	Average result per trade. Day trades: % of account at 1% risk. Swing: account % at 10% per position.
Profit factor (PF)	Gross winnings divided by gross losses. Above 1 makes money; 1.5 is good for a day-trading rule.
Max drawdown	Largest fall from a running peak of the cumulative result, trade by trade.
Green days	Sessions whose trades summed to a gain, out of all sessions in the window.
Opening range	The high and low of the first five minutes after the 09:30 open.
Risk (1x)	The distance from entry to the initial stop. A 2x target is twice that distance.
EXPIRED signal	A signal first seen more than 2 minutes after its bar closed. Posted as information, not as a trade.
Sources	tradingbot: reports/channel_stats.json, channel_trades.json, orb_research.md, orb_checks.md, orb_improve.md, orb_bench.md. vwap-ema-swing: config.yaml, research backtest on Yahoo hourly data refreshed 3 Oct, state/state.json for open positions.
Windows	Last week = 28 Sep – 2 Oct; last month = 3 Sep – 2 Oct (21 sessions); last 3 months = 7 Jul – 2 Oct (63 sessions).

Past results, live or simulated, don't predict future ones. Nothing in this report is financial advice.